

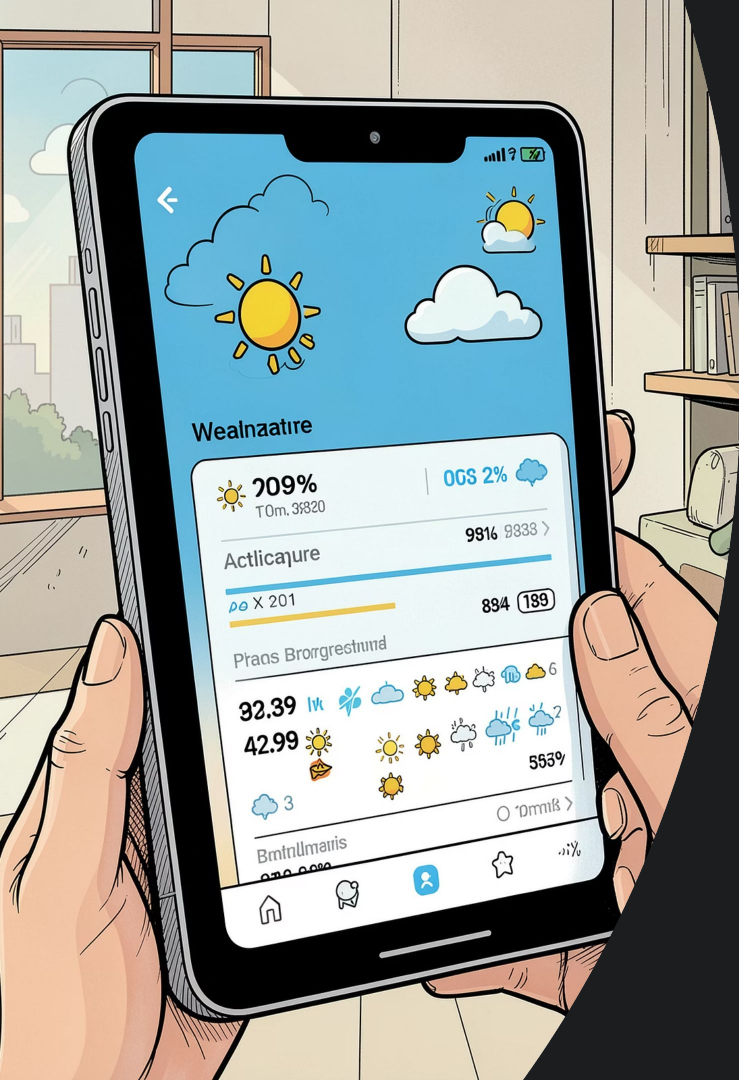


WeatherApp

Real-time weather updates using the Observer pattern

A Java project that demonstrates how to use the Observer design pattern to build a flexible, scalable system for monitoring weather data and distributing updates.

Raneem Alhameed, Sidra Wali, Rahaf Atmah



Project Overview

WeatherApp is a Java application that fetches weather data from the **OpenWeatherMap API** and automatically distributes it to multiple observers when the data changes. The project demonstrates how to build scalable systems using design patterns.



API

OpenWeatherMap for fetching live weather data



Java

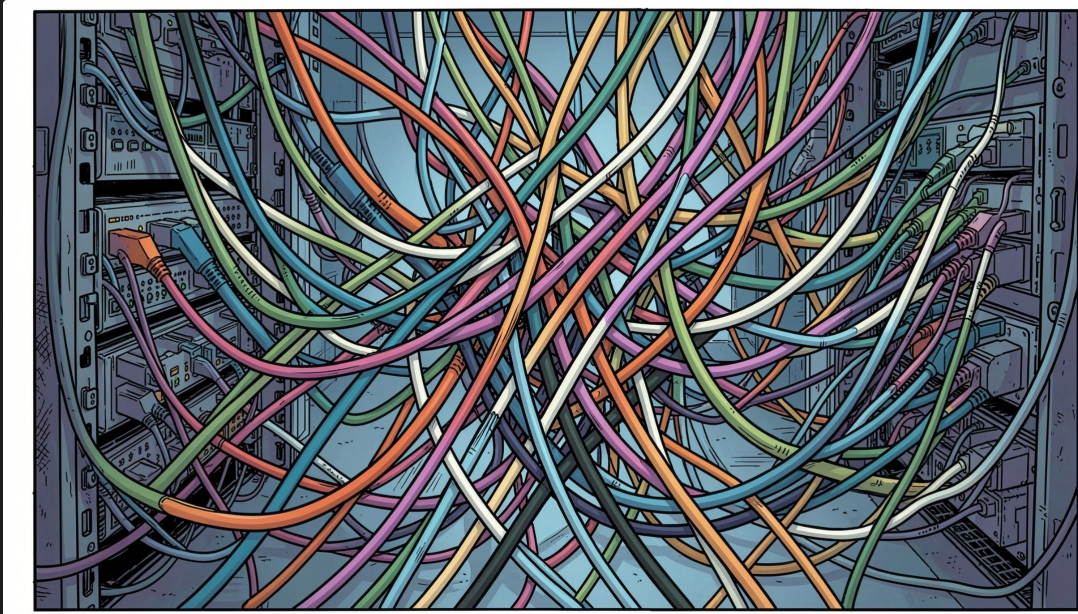
The project's primary programming language



Gson

Used to convert JSON into Java objects

Problem Statement



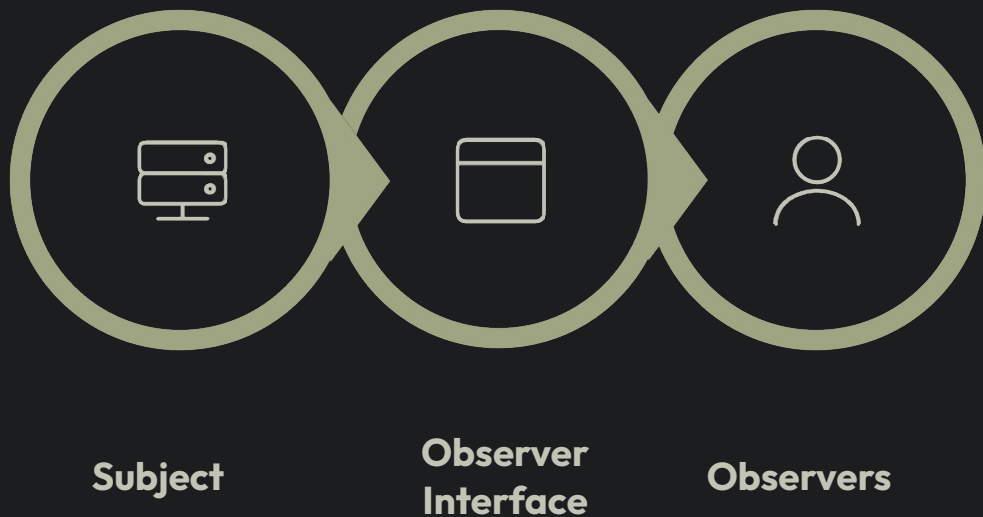
The Main Challenge

When building a system that fetches weather data and notifies multiple parties, a key challenge emerges: **how to separate the data-fetching logic from the notification logic** without creating tight coupling between components.

- Adding a new observer requires modifying the core code
- Difficulty testing each component independently
- Lack of flexibility when notification requirements change

Observer Pattern Principle

The Observer pattern is a behavioral design pattern that allows multiple objects (observers) to monitor another object (the subject) and respond automatically to any changes that occur — without direct coupling.



In WeatherApp: **WeatherService** notifies both **ConsoleObserver** and **EmailObserver** when weather data changes.

Why Observer Pattern?

Separation of Responsibilities

WeatherService is completely decoupled from the observers — each component works independently.

High Flexibility

New observers can be added or removed without modifying the core service code.

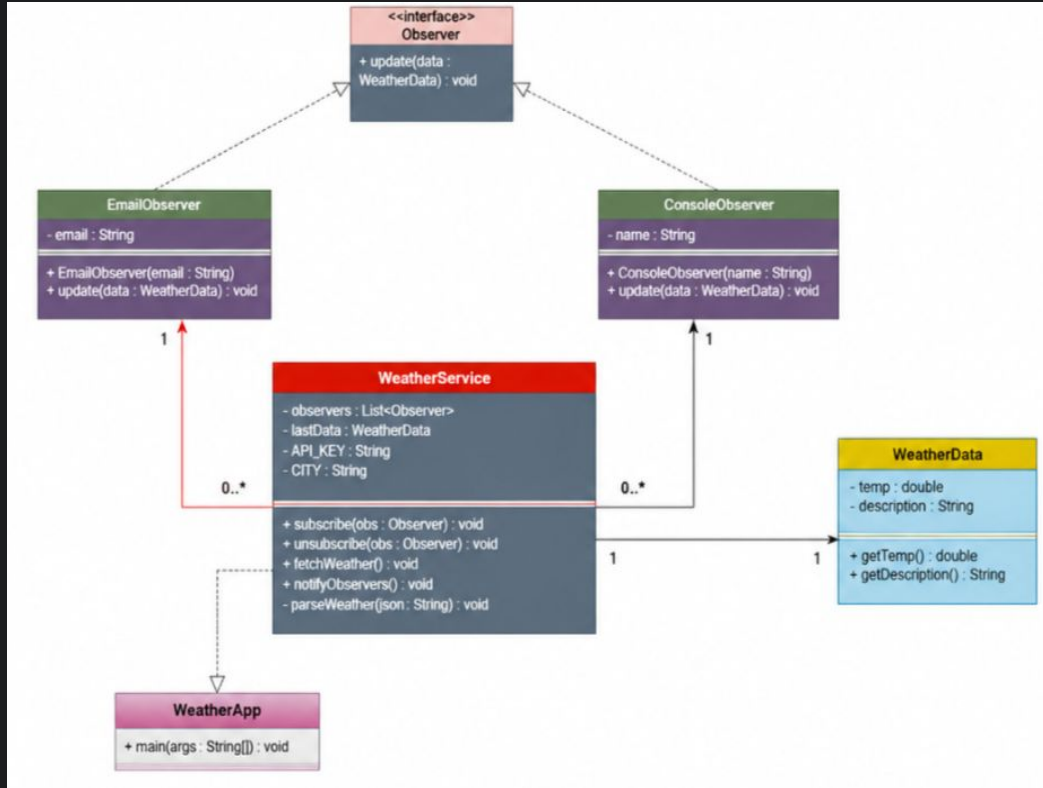
Instant Updates

Immediate notifications are sent to all observers when data changes, efficiently.

Easy to Test

Each observer can be tested independently without relying on the service.

System Design and UML Diagram



Relationships Between Classes

The diagram shows the complete system structure and the connections between its components:

- **WeatherService** — the main subject (Subject)
- **Observer** — the interface implemented by all observers
- **ConsoleObserver** — prints data in the terminal
- **EmailObserver** — sends alerts via email
- **WeatherData** — an object that holds weather data
- **WeatherApp** — the entry point and component assembler

User Flow Scenario

Here are the steps the system goes through from the beginning until the observers are notified:



Initialize WeatherService

Create an instance of the service with the OpenWeatherMap API key



Subscribe Observers

Register ConsoleObserver and EmailObserver with the service



Fetch and Parse Data

Call the API and parse the JSON response using Gson



Notify Observers

Call `update()` for each registered observer when the data changes



Next: Let's review the implementation code together 🔍

Summary and Key Points



Design Flexibility

Add new observers without touching the core service code



Easy Maintenance

Each component is independent and can be tested and modified separately



Instant Notifications

All observers receive updates as soon as the weather data changes



Complete Separation

Observers do not know about one another — coupling is zero between components